

10 Prompts That Win Business

A ready-to-use prompt library for proposals, outreach, and prospect research. Works with Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, or any AI model you already use.

From HitLai Institute — Module S1: “AI That Wins You More Business”

HOW TO USE THIS SHEET

Every prompt follows the **CTCF framework** — **C**ontext, **T**ask, **C**onstraints, **F**ormat. AI works best when you tell it *who you are, what you need, what rules to follow, and how to structure the answer*. Copy a prompt, swap the [bracketed text] for your own details, paste into your AI tool of choice.

Safety note: Never paste client names, pricing, or contract terms into a public AI tool without checking your company’s data policy first. If you’re unsure, replace real names with placeholders (“Prospect A”) before prompting.

PROPOSALS & QUOTES

1. First-draft proposal from an RFP or inquiry > I run a [type of business]. A prospect just sent me this inquiry: [paste inquiry]. Draft a 1-page proposal covering: what we’ll deliver, timeline, investment range, and next step. My pricing for this type of work typically runs [range]. Use a confident, consultative tone — not salesy. Format as: Problem → Approach → Timeline → Investment → Next Step.

2. Turn a capability statement into a tailored proposal > Here’s our standard capabilities: [paste 3-4 sentences]. Here’s what the prospect said they need: [paste their description]. Write a proposal that connects *our* capabilities to *their* specific language. Mirror their words where possible. End with two proposed next steps — one low-commitment, one decisive.

3. Executive summary for a long proposal > Read this proposal: [paste]. Write a 4-sentence executive summary a busy CFO would read first. Lead with the business outcome, not our methodology.

OUTREACH & FOLLOW-UP

4. 2-minute prospect research > Research [Company Name] (website: [url]). Pull together: what they do in plain language, their likely top 3 business priorities this year, any recent news or leadership changes, and 2 specific angles someone selling [your offering] could use to open a conversation. Cite your sources.

5. Personalized cold outreach (LinkedIn or email) > Write a 4-sentence outreach message to [Name, Title at Company]. Their company recently [paste fact from research]. We help companies like theirs [one-sentence value prop]. Don’t use “I hope this email finds you well” or anything that sounds like a template. End with a specific, low-friction ask — a 15-minute call on a named topic, not a generic “chat.”

6. Re-engage a cold prospect > We spoke with [Name at Company] on [date] about [topic]. They went quiet. Write a re-engagement email that references our last conversation, offers one new piece of value (an insight, a template, a relevant case), and asks a single low-friction question. Under 100 words.

RESPONSES & NEGOTIATION

7. Handle a price objection without discounting > A prospect said: “[paste their objection].” Write three response options: (a) reframe the value against the alternative of doing nothing, (b) offer a smaller starting scope instead of a discount, (c) surface the real concern with one diagnostic question. Keep each under 80 words.

8. Respond to “send me more information” > A prospect said “send me more information” without specifying what. Write a reply that asks one sharp question to uncover what they actually want to know — framed around their situation, not our product catalog.

INTERNAL PREP

9. Pre-call briefing > I have a call in 30 minutes with [Name, Title at Company]. Here’s what I know so far: [paste notes]. Give me: 3 questions to ask, 2 things to listen for, 1 story from our work that would be relevant to their situation, and the single most important outcome I should aim for on this call.

10. Win/loss debrief > We just [won/lost] a deal with [Company]. Here’s what happened: [paste notes]. Ask me the 5 questions a sales coach would ask to extract the real lesson — not the story I tell myself. After I answer, summarize the pattern and what to do differently next time.

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU OUTGROW THIS SHEET

These prompts work. Within a month you’ll hit the ceiling: you’ll copy-paste proposals into your CRM by hand, your pricing will drift between team members, follow-ups will fall through the cracks, and you’ll have no way to see which AI-assisted proposals actually won.

That’s the moment you’re not really fighting the AI tool — you’re fighting the gap between AI, your team, and the systems your team works in (CRM, calendar, email, pricing docs).

The HitLai answer in one line:

AI tools, your team, your systems — running together, safely.

For the proposal use case: your CRM data feeds the draft, your approved pricing is the source of truth, your team gets the proposal in their approval queue, send and follow-up get scheduled in the same flow. Works with what you’ve got — Microsoft 365, your CRM, the AI you already use. What we don’t have a connector for, the platform builds automatically in minutes.

You stay in charge. AI starts where you’re comfortable — watching, suggesting, executing-with-approval — and earns the right to do more, one workflow at a time.

Want to see your proposal flow run in real time? Join the next HitLai Institute Module S1 session. We'll set it up live with your data. → hitlai.net/institute

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